



ABDUL KHALIQ

AUTOMATE YOUR APPROVALS WORKFLOW WITH SHAREPOINT & POWER AUTOMATE





ABDUL KHALIQ

WHAT DO YOU NEED?

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS
ACCOUNTS PAYABLE
INVOICES AS AN
EXAMPLE



ABDUL KHALIQ

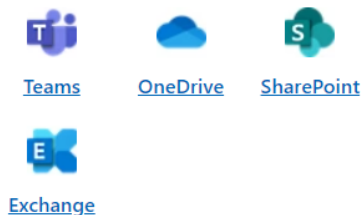
STEP 1: MICROSOFT 365 SUBSCRIPTION

1

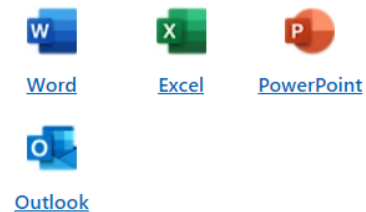
Obtain a Microsoft 365 Business Subscription

- Visit the Microsoft 365 Business Subscription page.
- Choose the appropriate plan and follow the instructions to subscribe.

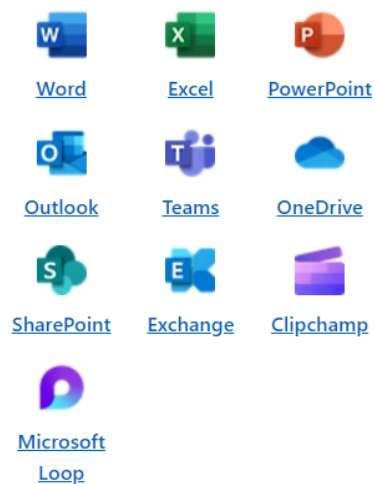
Secure cloud services:



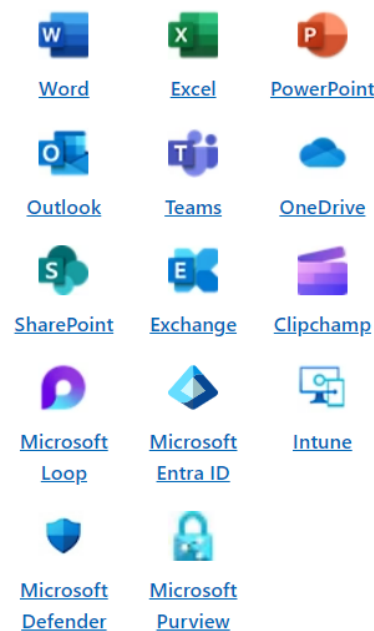
Web and mobile apps only:



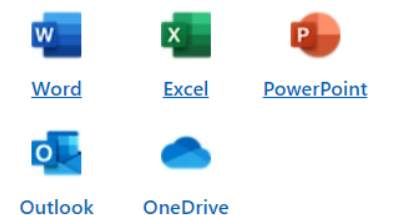
Desktop, web, and mobile apps and secure cloud services:



Desktop, web, and mobile apps and secure cloud services:



Desktop, web, and mobile apps and secure cloud services:





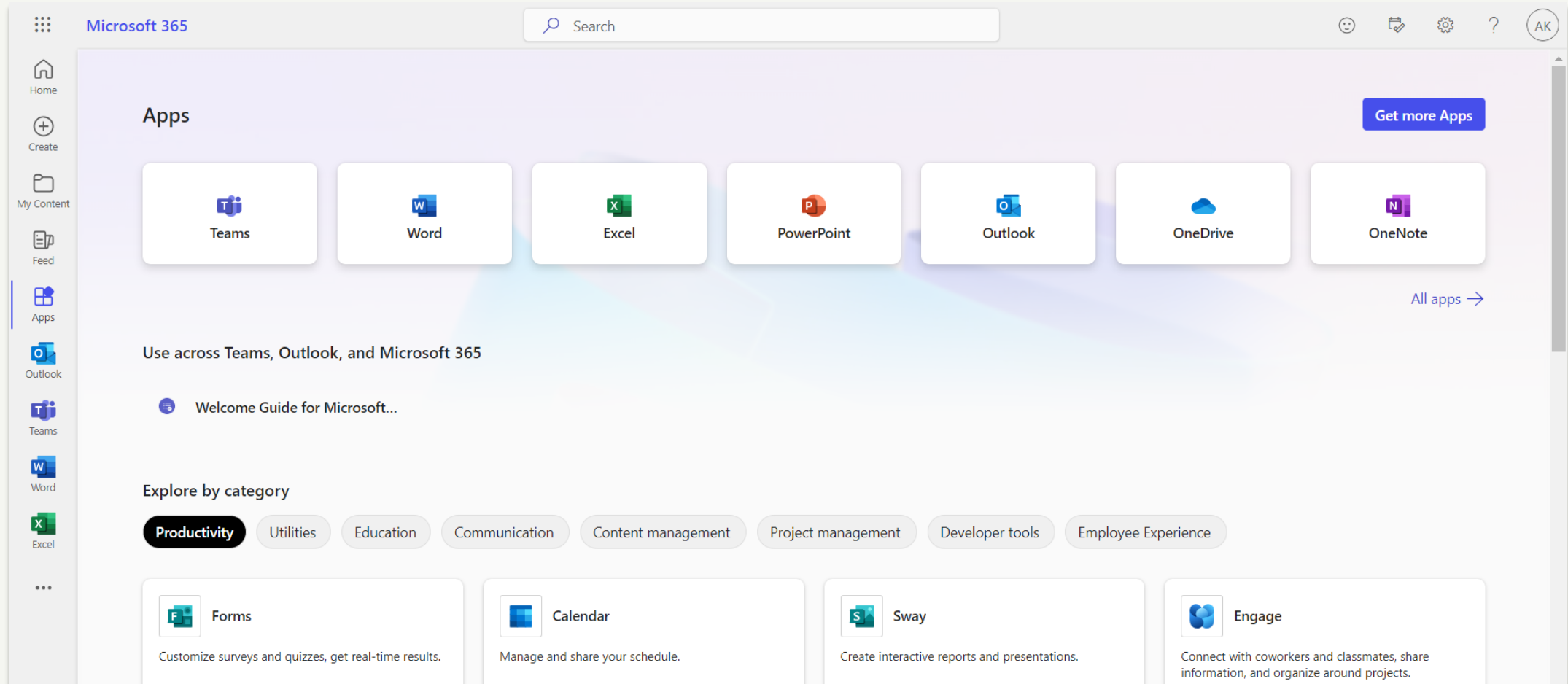
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 1: MICROSOFT 365 SUBSCRIPTION

2

Obtain a Microsoft 365 Business Subscription

- Once subscribed, your Apps screen may look like this, depending on your plan.





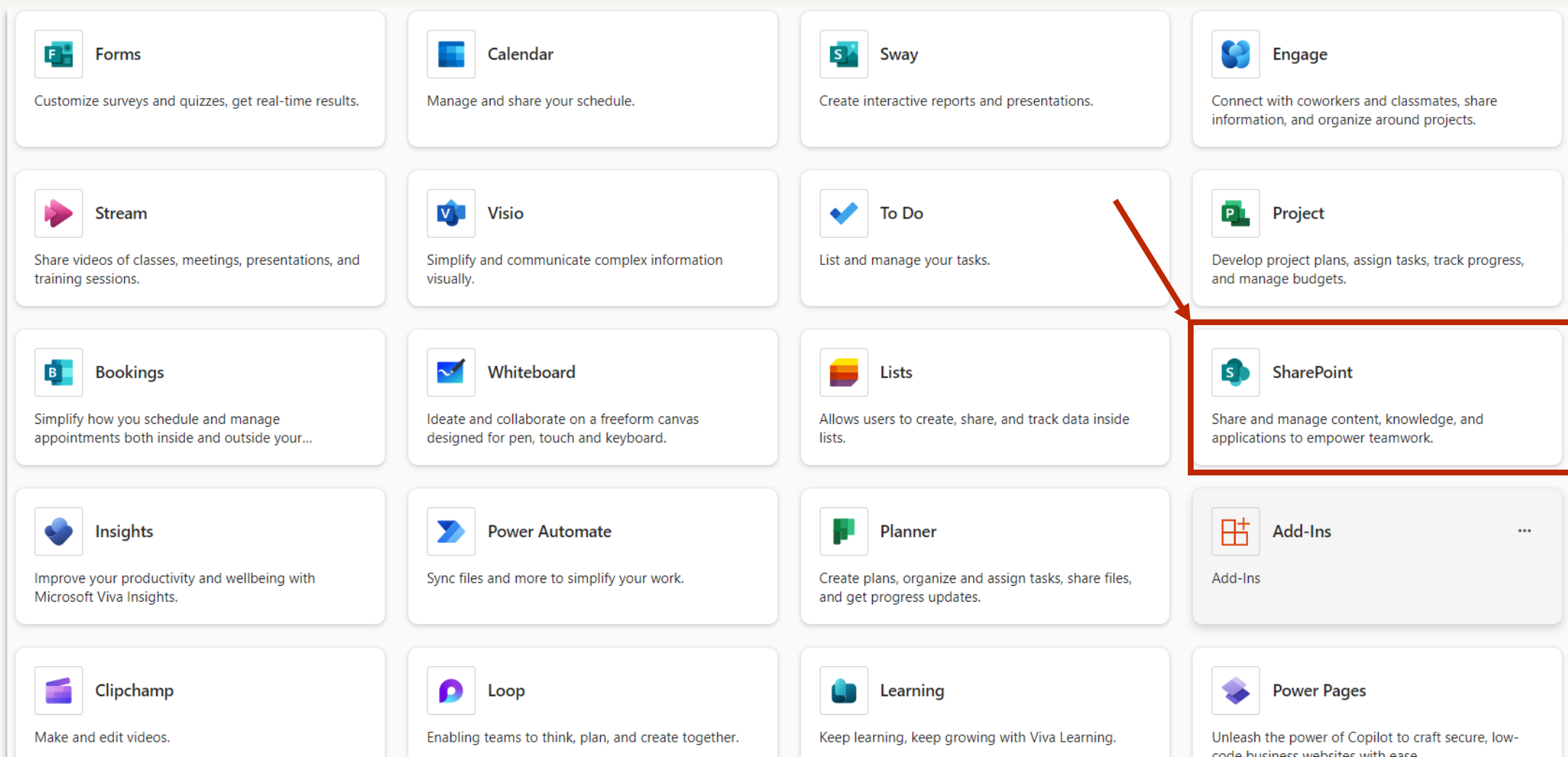
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 2: ACCESSING SHAREPOINT

1

Click on SharePoint

- Log in to your Microsoft 365 account.
- In the Microsoft 365 App Launcher, click on the SharePoint icon.





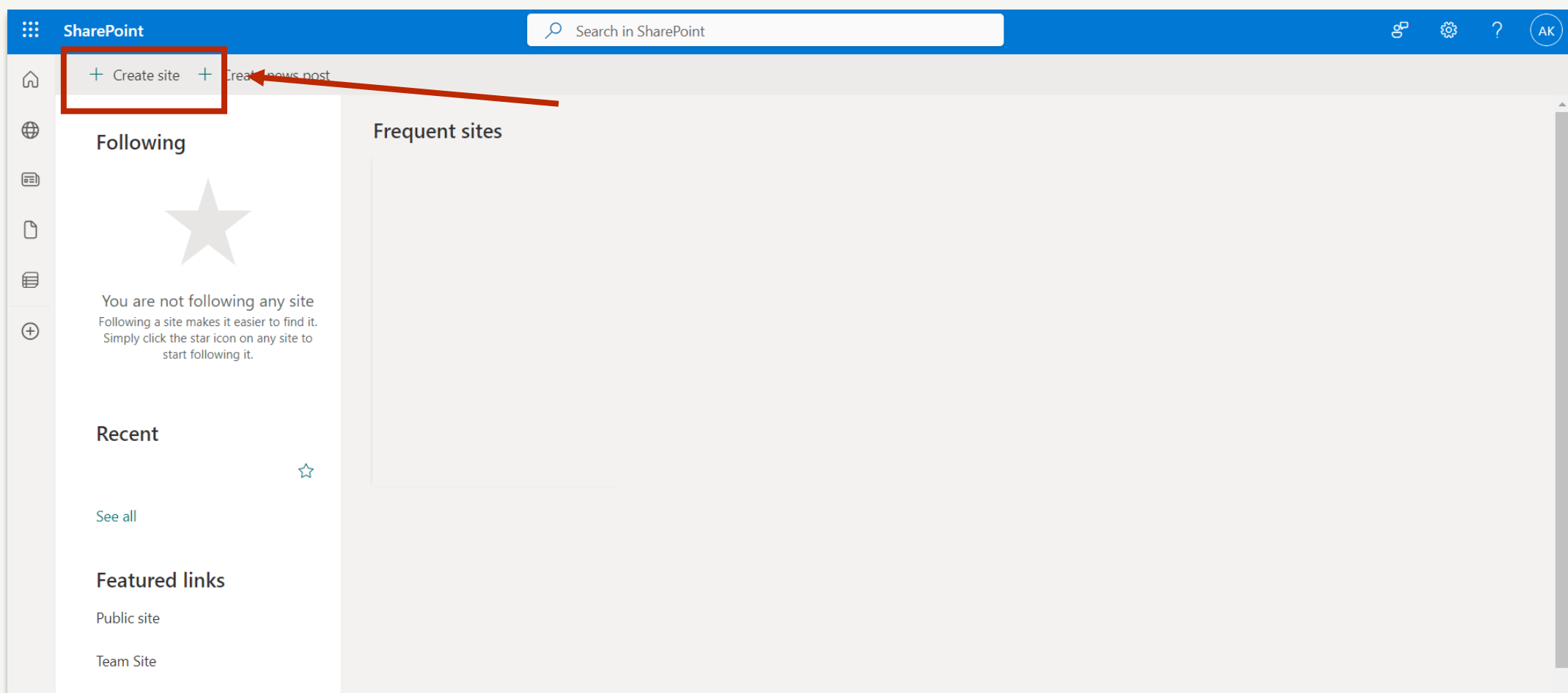
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

1

Create a Team Site

- Click on "Create site" on the SharePoint home page.





ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

2

Create a Team Site

- Select "Team site"

Create a site: Select the site type

Select the type of site you want to create. [Learn more about team sites](#) or [learn more about communication sites](#).



Team site

Create a private space to collaborate with your team.

- 📅 Track and stay updated on project status
- 🔄 Share team resources and co-author content
- 👥 All site owners and members publish site content
- 🔗 Can connect to other Microsoft 365 products



Communication site

Share information that engages a broad audience.

- 📄 Create a portal or subject-focused site
- 👥 Engage dozens or thousands of viewers
- 👤 Few content authors and many site visitors



ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

3

Create a Team Site

- You can select a template based on what you plan to create.
- We will use a “Standard Team” template

Select a template

From Microsoft

From your organization

Standard Team

Manage projects, share content, and stay cc your team.

Crisis communication team

Centralize crisis communication, resources, and best practices.

Employee onboarding team

Guide new employees through your team's onboarding process.

Event planning

Coordinate and plan event details with your team.

IT Help Desk

Welcome to the IT help desk

Project Management

Project launch timeline

Retail Management Team

Hours and announcements

Store Collaboration

Weekly store announcements

You can change the site template later under Settings.

Back

Follow [Abdul Khaliq](#) on LinkedIn

THE FINANCE
MASTERCLASS

Like

Share

Comment

Follow



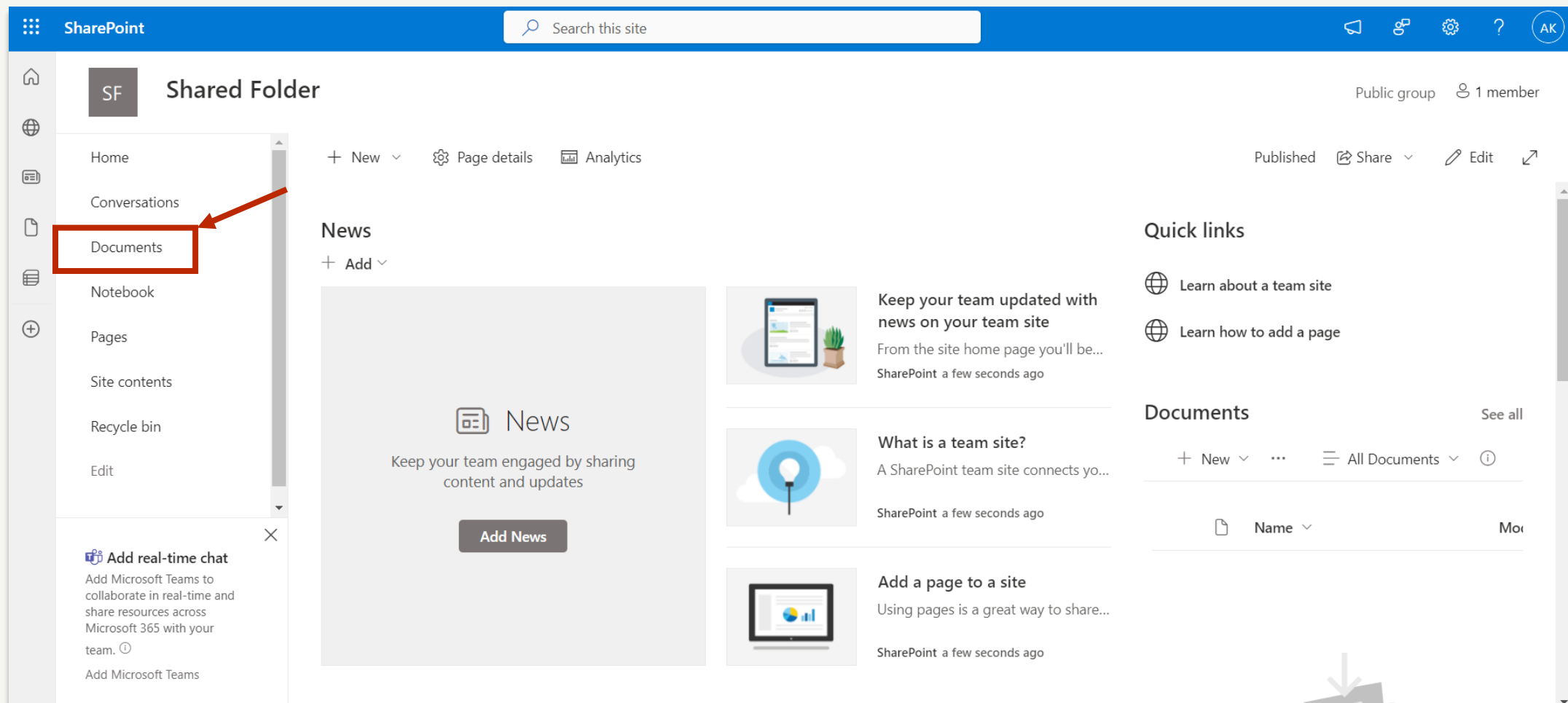
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

4

Create a Team Site

- Once you have provided initial information, you will have a page as illustrated in the image below.
- Click on 'Documents' to start creating folders.





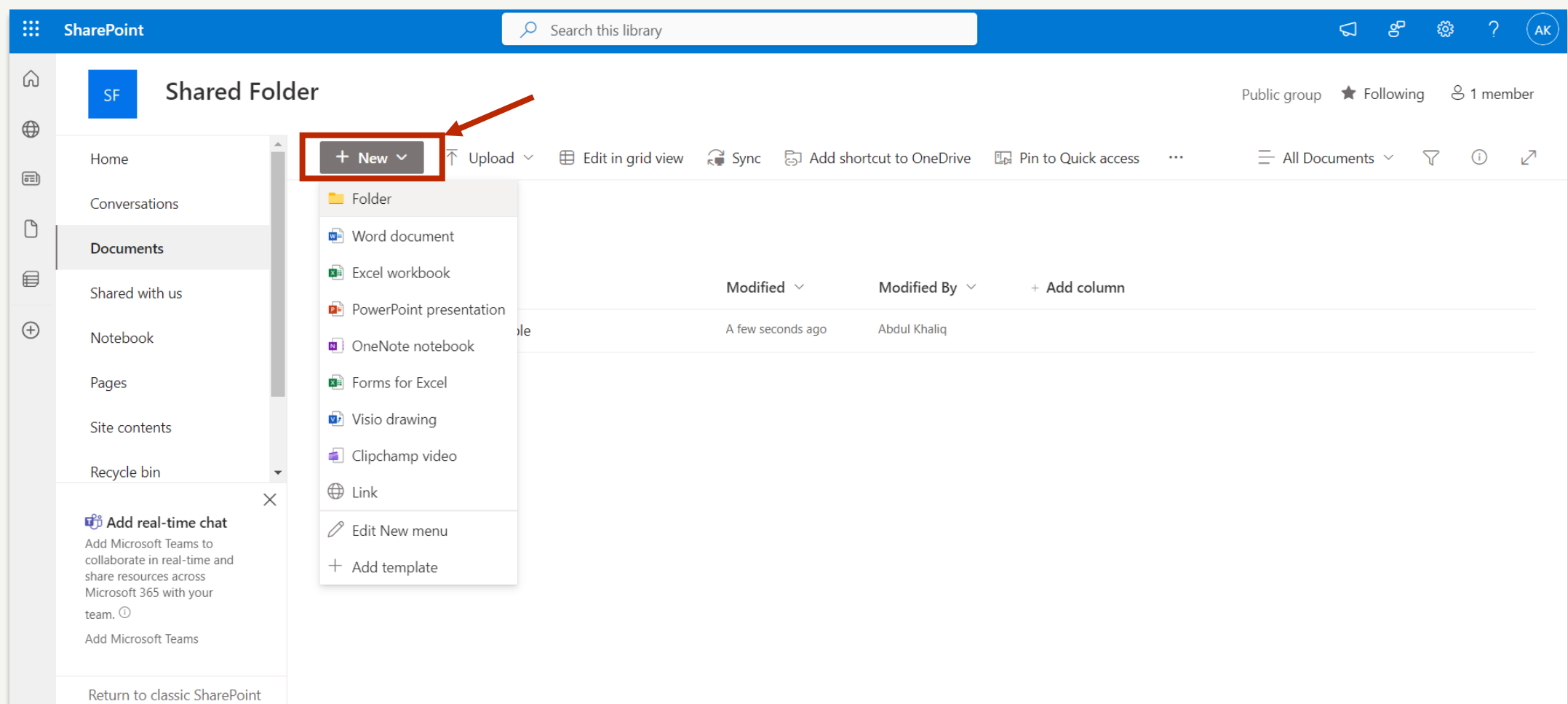
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 4: CUSTOMIZE THE TEAM SITE

1

Customize the Site

- Navigate to your newly created team site.
- Customize the site by adding necessary libraries and lists.





ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 4: CUSTOMIZE THE TEAM SITE

2

Customize the Site

- Create a document library named "Invoices."
- Within the "Invoices" library, create two folders: "Pending" and "Approved."

The screenshot displays the SharePoint interface for a 'Shared Folder' (SF). The left sidebar shows navigation options: Home, Conversations, Documents (selected), Shared with us, Notebook, Pages, Site contents, and Recycle bin. The main area shows the 'Invoices' document library. A table lists the contents:

Name	Modified	Modified By
Approved	A few seconds ago	Abdul Khaliq
Pending	A few seconds ago	Abdul Khaliq

A red arrow points to the 'Approved' folder name, and a red box highlights the 'Pending' folder name.



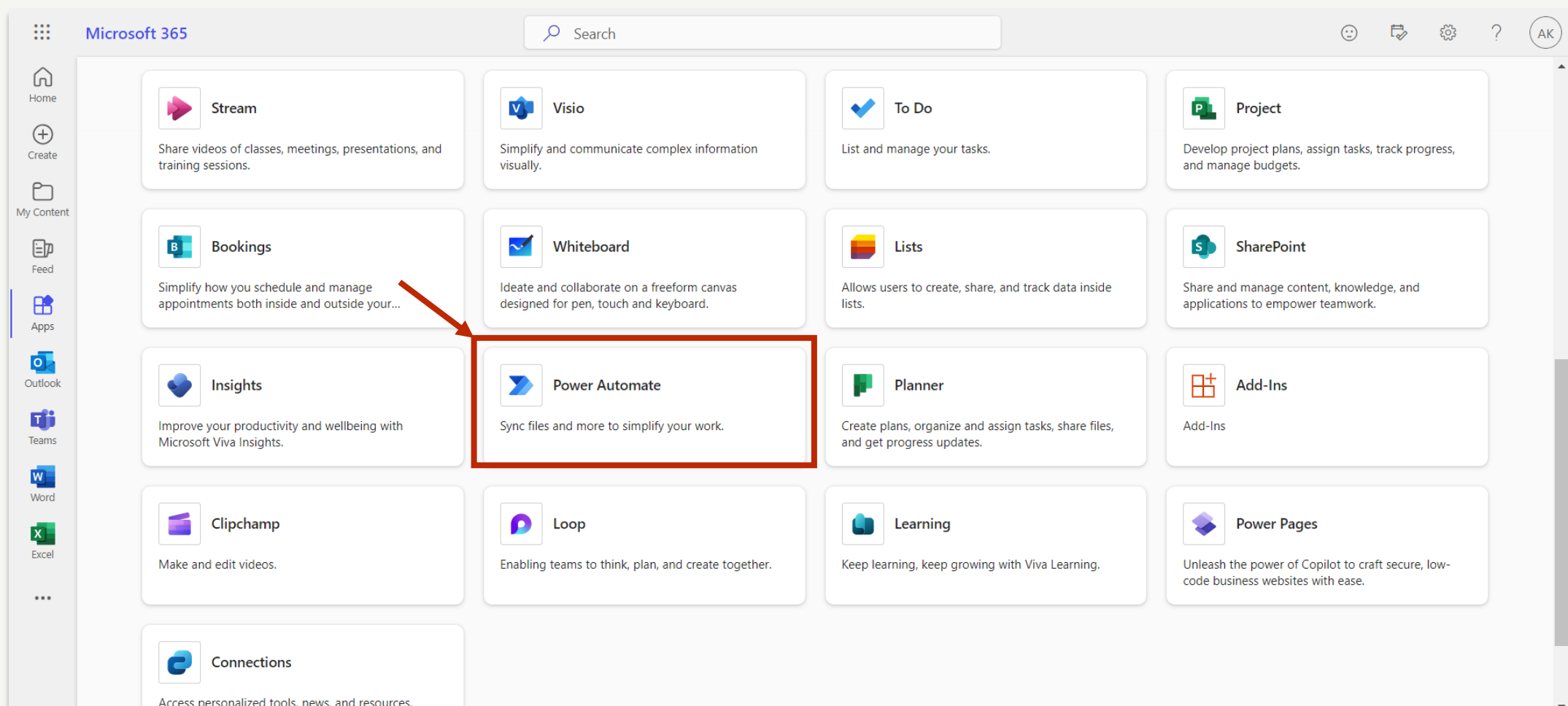
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

1

Go to Power Automate

- In the Microsoft 365 App Launcher, click on the Power Automate icon.



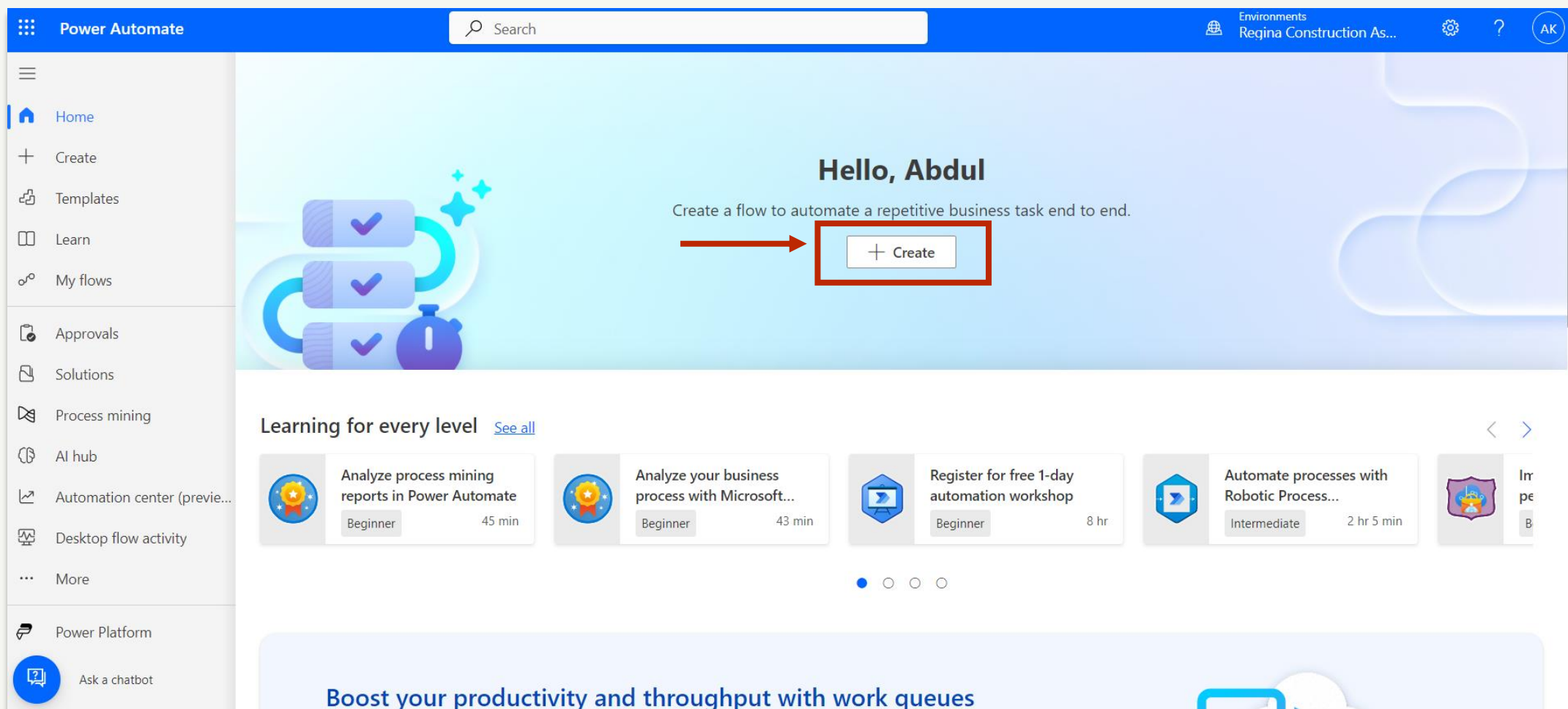


ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

2 Create an Automated Flow

- A new screen will open as illustrated below.
- Click on "Create".





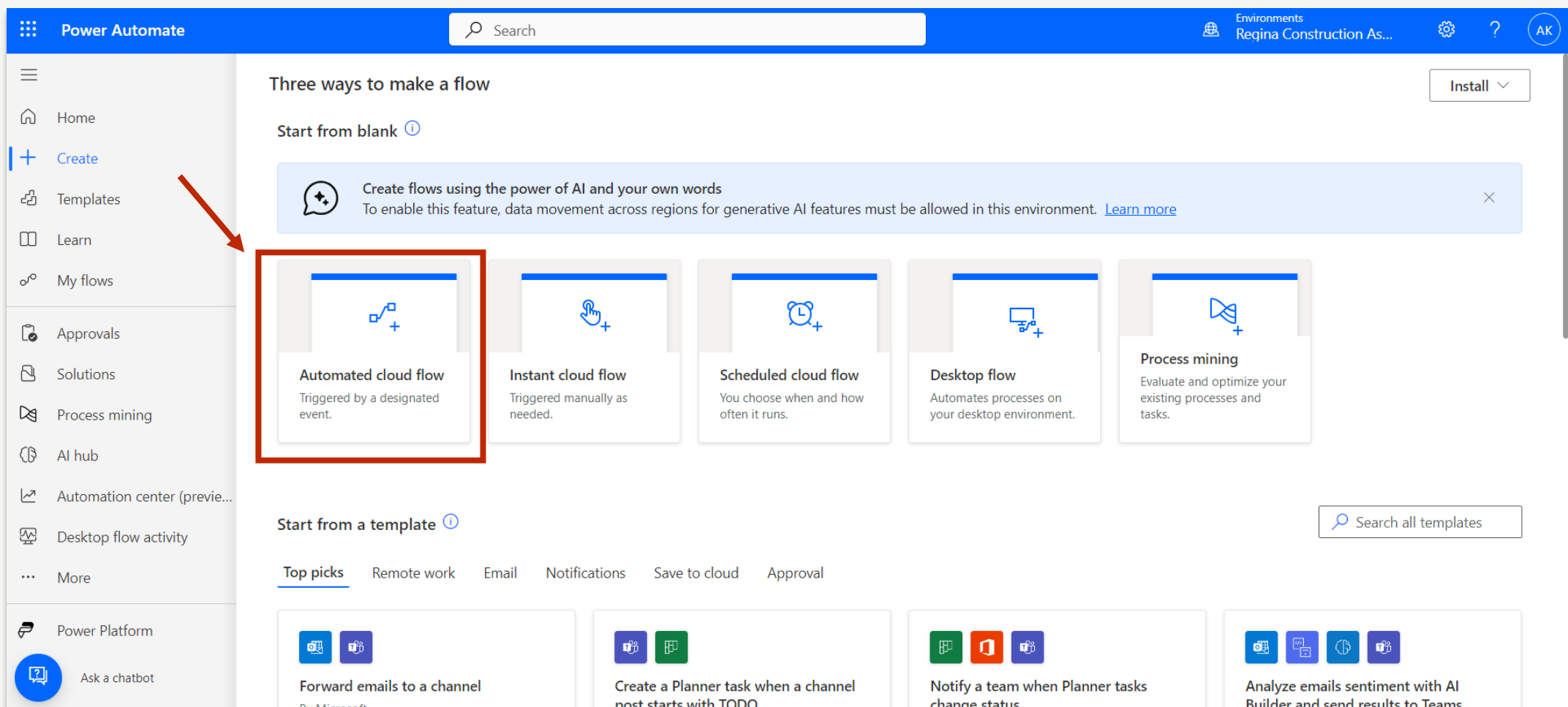
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

3

Create an Automated Flow

- A new screen will open as illustrated below.
- Click on "Create".





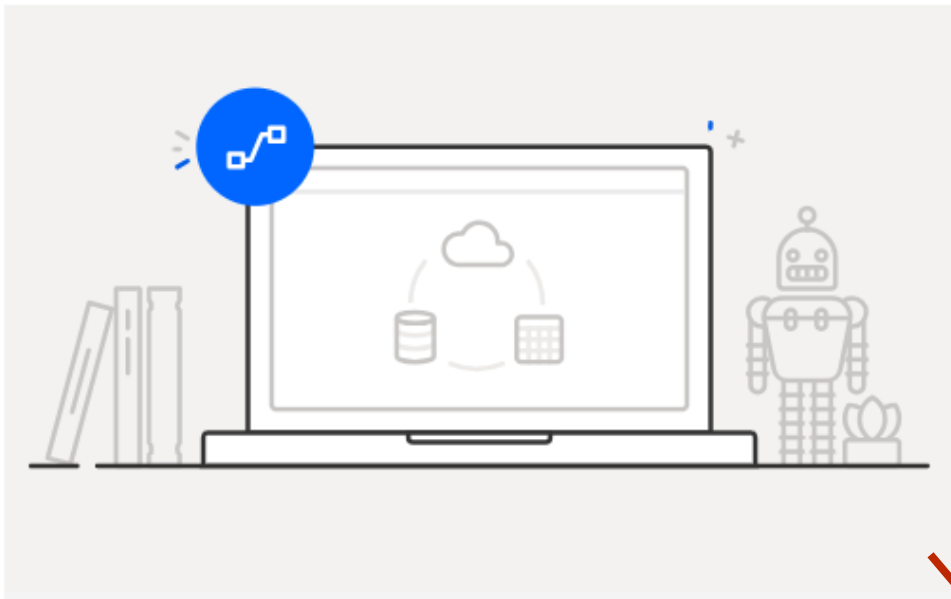
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

4 Create an Automated Flow

- In the "Build an automated flow" screen, search for "When a file is created or modified (properties only)" SharePoint trigger.

Build an automated cloud flow



Free yourself from repetitive work just by connecting the apps you already use—automate alerts, reports, and other tasks.

Examples:

- Automatically collect and store data in business solutions
- Generate reports via custom queries on your SQL database

Flow name

Invoice Approval Flow

Choose your flow's trigger *

Search or select a trigger from the list below to create a flow. (Required)

Search all triggers

When a new response is submitted
Microsoft Forms

When an item is created
SharePoint

✓ When an item is created or modified
SharePoint

When a file is created
OneDrive for Business

When a task is assigned to me
Planner



ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

5

Create an Automated Flow

- Or ask AI to create the approval workflow for you automatically.
- You can also choose from suggested options.

Power Automate

Search

Environments
Regina Construction As...

Let's automate something. What should it do?

When a new file is created on Sharepoint, trigger an approval workflow

Generate

Suggested flow descriptions

- ⌚ Create an approval when a new file is created in sharepoint
- ⚡ If a new file is created in a sharepoint library, trigger an approval and email process
- ⚡ Create an approval when a new file is created in sharepoint
- ⚡ Start an approval process when a new file is created in sharepoint
- ⚡ When a new file is created in sharepoint, create a planner task and start an approval process
- ⚡ Start an approval process when a file is modified in a sharepoint library, and copy or update the file depending on the approval result

Learning for every level [See all](#)

Analyze process mining reports in Power Automate
Beginner 45 min

Beginner 43 min

Beginner 8 hr

Automate processes with Robotic Process...
Intermediate 2 hr 5 min

Power Platform

Ask a chatbot



ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

6

Create an Automated Flow

- AI will generate the suggested process.
- Click 'Next' to continue.

Power Automate

Search

Environments
Regina Construction As...

Describe it to design it

Step 1 of 2

What will your flow do?

Describe what you want to automate and AI will help you make it happen. [How it works](#)

Suggested flow

After you review this AI generated flow suggestion, select **Next** to configure it

Trigger
The flow starts when this happens

When a file is created in a folder (deprecated)
SharePoint

Actions
This is what the flow will do

Create an approval
Approvals

[This isn't what I'm looking for](#)

Next

Cancel



ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

7 Create an Automated Flow

- Click on each action and provide the information displayed in the box.
- Click 'Save' once done.

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Power Automate web interface. The top navigation bar includes the 'Power Automate' logo, a search bar, and user information for 'Regina Construction As...'. The main workspace shows a workflow titled 'When a new file is created on Sharepoint, trigger an approval workflow'. On the left, a panel for the 'When a file is created in a folder (deprecated)' trigger is open, showing parameters for 'Site Address' (https://reginaconstructiona.sharepoint.com/sites/SharedFolder) and 'Folder Id' (/Lists/Invoices). The main canvas shows the workflow steps: the trigger followed by a connector and then the 'Create an approval 1' action. Red arrows point to the 'Save' button in the top right and to the trigger and action boxes in the workflow canvas.



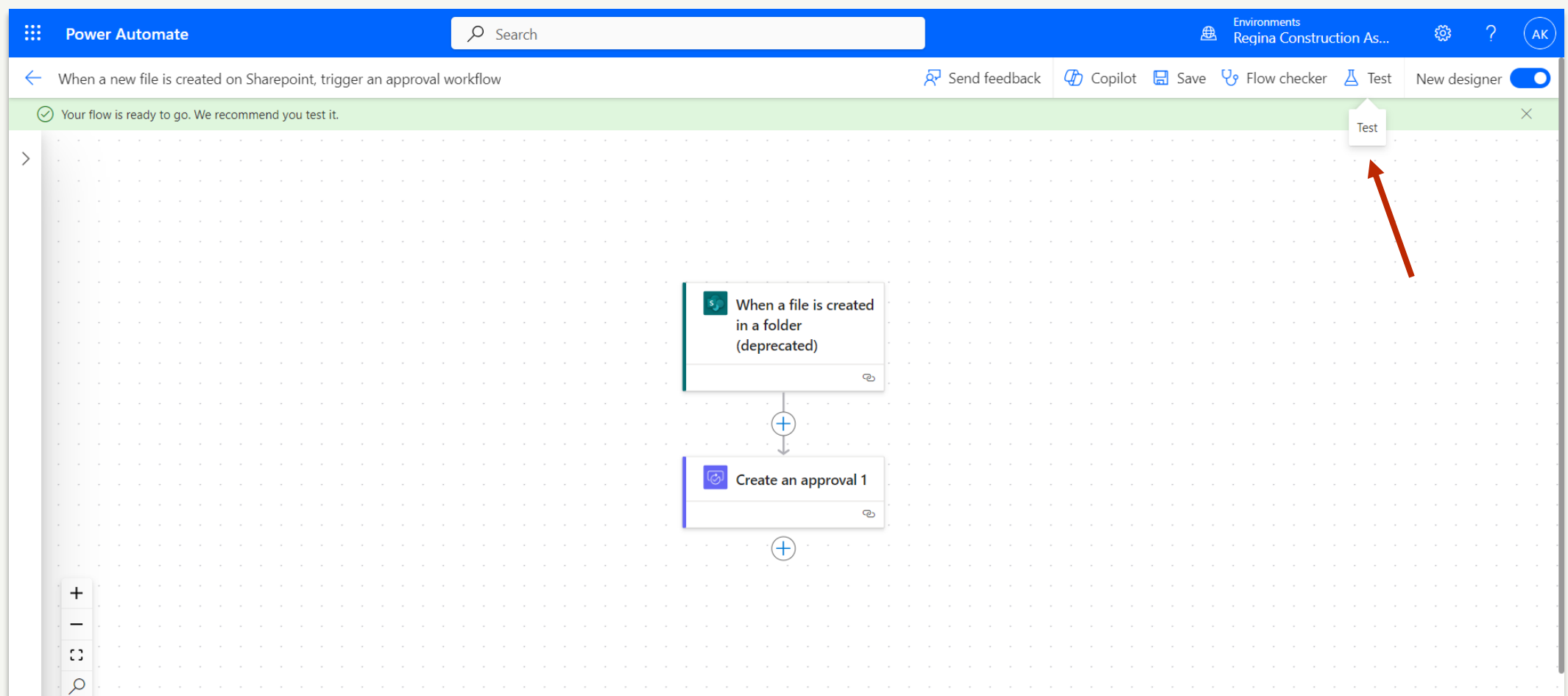
ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

8

Create an Automated Flow

- Click 'Test' to test your flow.



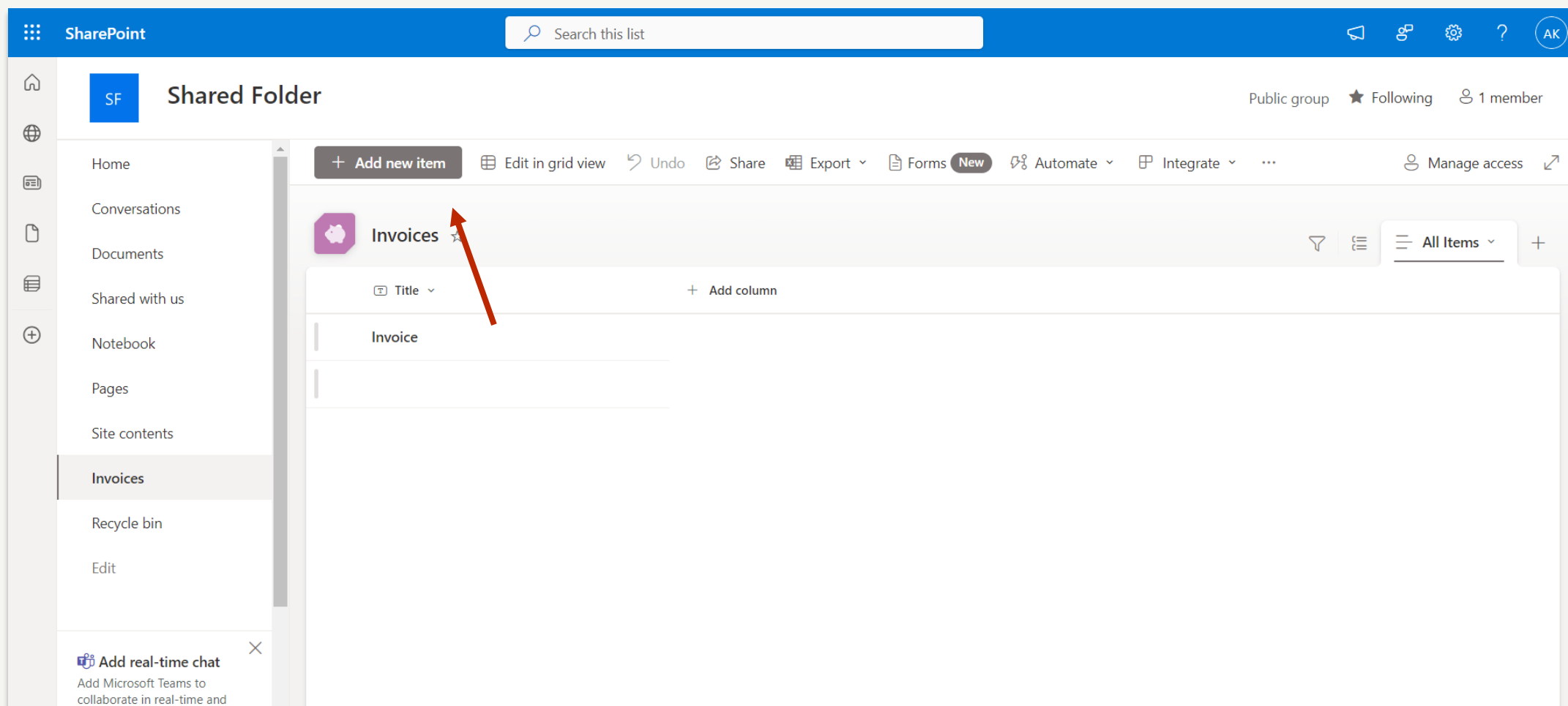


ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 6: TEST THE APPROVAL FLOW

1 Create an Automated Flow

- Test the flow by uploading a file to the folder in the SharePoint site and check if it triggers the approval process.



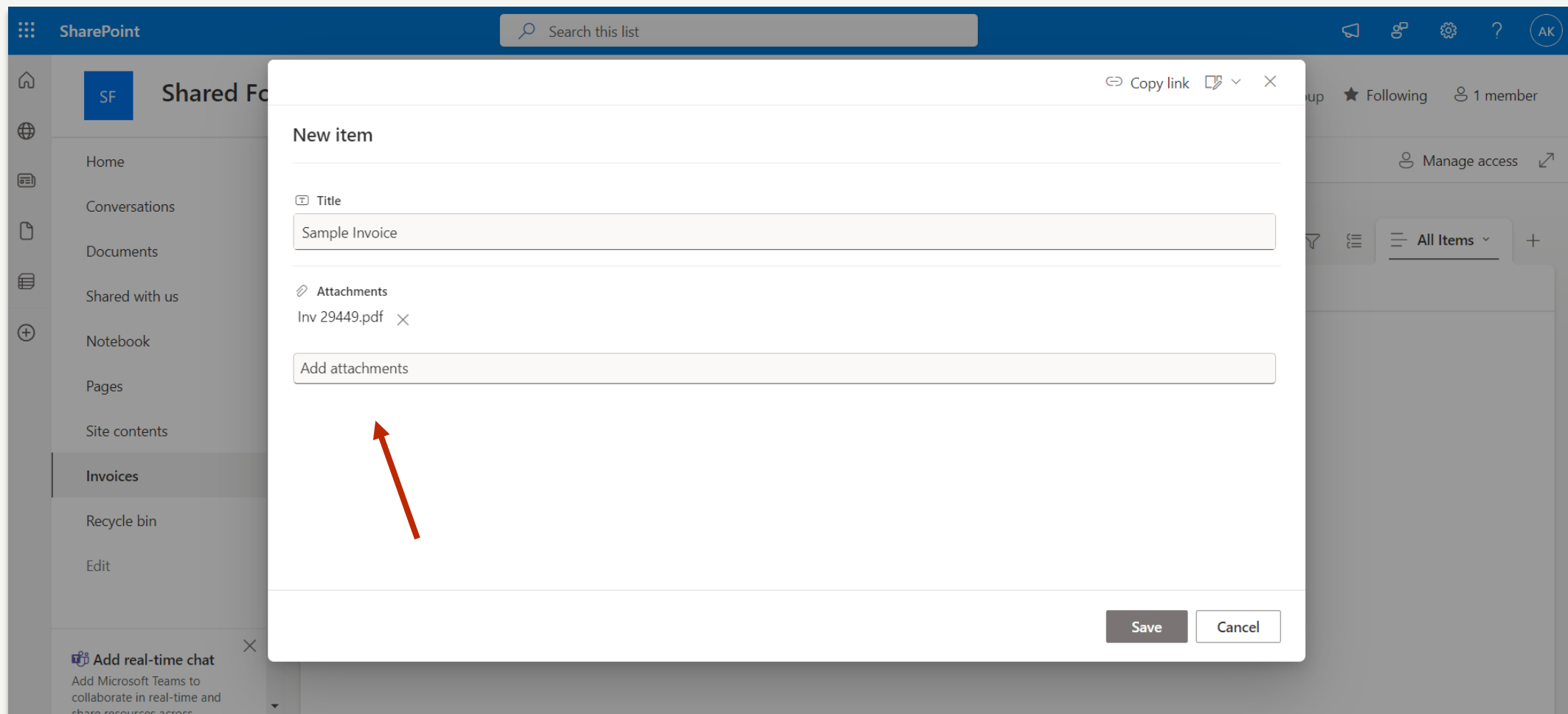


ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 6: TEST THE APPROVAL FLOW

2 Create an Automated Flow

- Go to 'SharePoint' and upload a file to test your workflow.
- Click 'Save' to trigger the approval flow.



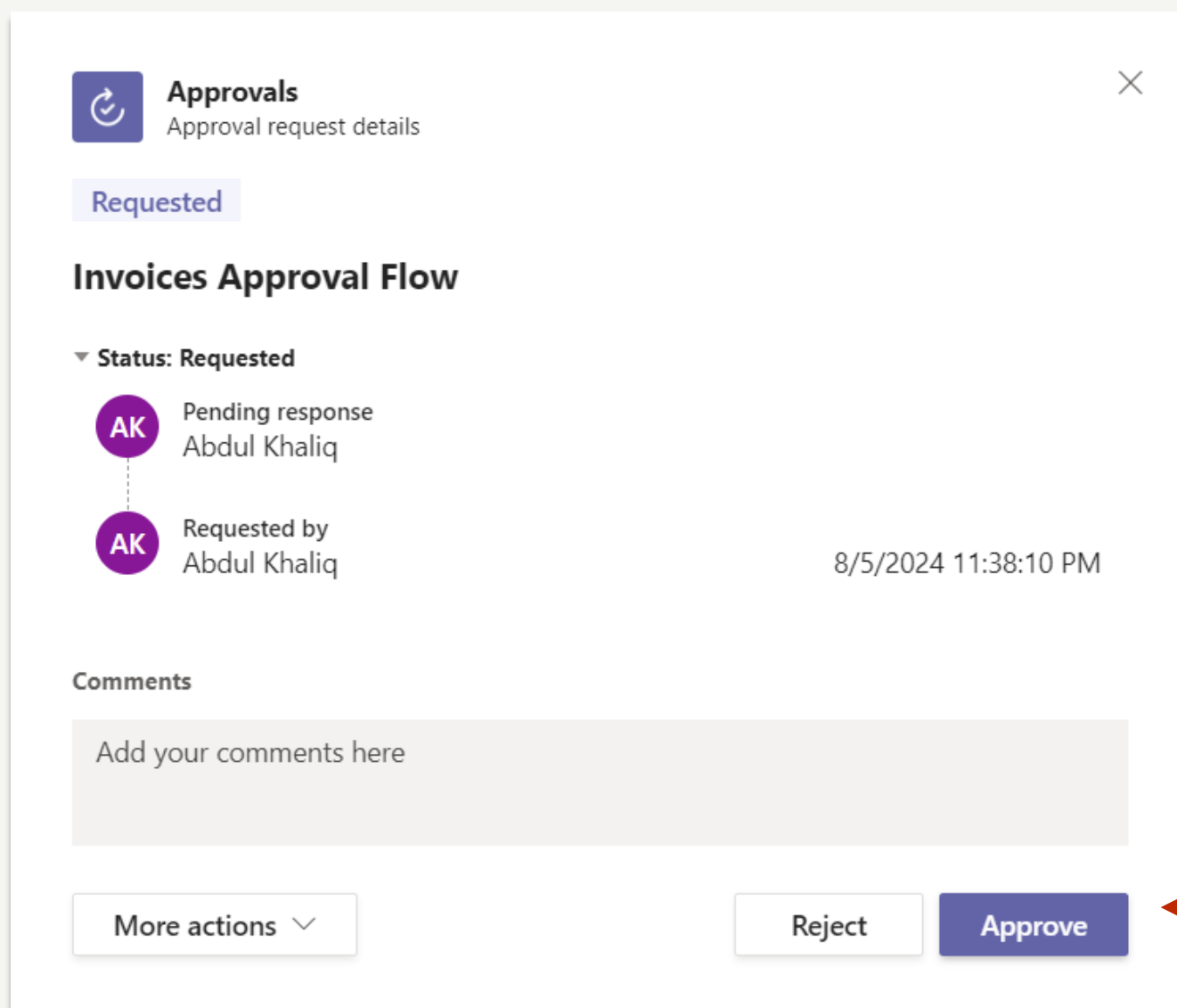
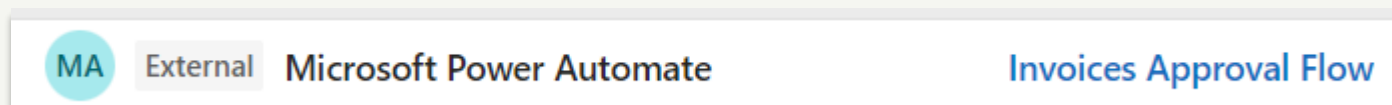


ABDUL KHALIQ

STEP 6: TEST THE APPROVAL FLOW

3 Create an Automated Flow

- You will receive a notification on Teams and on your email that new item has been added for approval.
- You will also receive an email notification.





ABDUL KHALIQ

CONGRATULATIONS

You just created an approval workflow!





ABDUL KHALIQ

NEED HELP?
CONTACT ME TO HELP YOU
IMPLEMENT THE AUTOMATED
WORKFLOW FOR YOU!

ABDUL KHALIQ

Fractional CFO/Controller | Helping SMEs
Drive Financial Success | Training and
Developing Future Finance Leaders



Like



Share



Comment



Follow

